

Vajrapāṇi Clad in Blue, the Tantra of the Vajra Resounding, Victor over the Three Realms

Nīlāmbaradhara Vajrapāṇi Vajrabhāṇaka Stantratrailokyavijaya nāma · Toh 457 · Derge Kangyur

ལག་ན་རྫོགས་སྒྲོ་མེད་པ་ཅན་རྫོགས་དང་པོ་ལྷ་ཁྱམས་གསུ་ལས་རྣམ་པར་རྒྱ་བ་ཞེས་བ་བྱ།

Toh 457 in the Kangyur is a tantric text known in English as "Vajrapāṇi Clad in Blue, the Tantra of the Vajra Resounding, Victor over the Three Realms," with a Sanskrit title reconstructed as Nīlāmbaradhara Vajrapāṇi Vajrabhāṇaka Tantra Trailokya Vijaya, and a Tibetan title of Lag na rdo rje gos sngon po can rdo rje gdengs pa'i rgyud khams gsum las rnam par rgyal ba. The text belongs to the tantra section of the Kangyur and centers on Vajrapāṇi, the powerful bodhisattva Lord of Secrets, here depicted in his wrathful blue-robed form as a deity who conquers and subdues all three realms of existence. The opening describes Vajrapāṇi entering a profound samādhi that causes the three realms to tremble, after which he emanates a mantra of tremendous power that strikes terror into nāgas and compels homage from all beings. As a tantric scripture, it belongs to the broader class of esoteric Buddhist literature concerned with ritual, mantra, and the wrathful enlightened activity associated with this important protector deity.

In the language of India: Nīlāmbaradhara Vajrapāṇi Vajrabhāṇaka Stantratrailokyavijaya nāma. In the language of Tibet: "Vajrapāṇi Clad in Blue, the Tantra of the Vajra Resounding, Victor over the Three Realms."

Homage to the glorious Vajra Fierce One.

Then the Lord of Secrets, having gazed upon that retinue, entered into meditative absorption — the samādhi called "Oneself as the Pure Space of the Sky." The very moment he entered into that samādhi, all three realms of existence trembled. Then, from the vajra of his own perfectly pure body, speech, and mind, he brought forth this mantra:

Om — by the mere utterance of the words "homage to the King of Secret Mantras,"

the earth and the grounds of the earth fall into a swoon,

and all the nāgas are seized with terror,

bowing in homage to the Lord of Secrets himself.

He who is endowed with compassion and steadfast in devotion,
who is reverent and possessed of the awakening mind,
moving in all directions with a settled and composed mind,
who makes equal offering to gods and to the guru,
and who is great in diligence and wisdom —
let such a one, for the benefit of oneself and others,
in a pleasant mountain cave full of delight,
or in a forest, by a lake, or in a garden,
purify the earth maṇḍala perfectly,
then anoint it well with scented water,
take a seat of ease,
and accomplish the Lord of Secrets.

Alternatively, a rough hermitage in the mountains,
or a charnel ground, or the house of Yama,
along with turbulence, distraction,
places seized by kings and roamed by fierce beings,
and whatever fearful regions there may be —
these too are the abodes for accomplishing the Victor.

Those with weak minds who arise in this age,
by the distraction of this very world,
give rise to all manner of gatherings.
The nature of the Dharma through the force of attachment
is this defect: not truly reflecting upon it —
this is comparable to an illusory elephant.

From the intrinsic nature of emptiness, free of conceptual elaboration,
the illusory body fully arises.

First is emptiness itself as the vajra;
second is the syllable Hūṃ;
third is the nine-pointed vajra;
fourth is the Blessed One, the Lord of Secrets;
fifth, the deity is fully complete.

The body arising from mirror-like wisdom, wisdom of equality,
and the wisdom of the dharmadhātu —
that body is itself the nature of wisdom;
and this is the great perfected wisdom.

From the wisdom body, through wisdom,
even emanations abide as wisdom itself.
Having transcended the afflictions of saṃsāra,
the Lord of Secrets dwells perfectly
in the fire-mass of non-conceptual wisdom.
The cause of liberation, of complete purification, of freedom —
the yoga of the true meaning, the self as Dharma in the form of mantra —
from wisdom, moment by moment,
the illusory body, like an illusion:
at the time of liberation within illusion itself —
Kye kye! Ha ha! Great hero!

He who is the foe of nāgas, the one who strikes fear,
the Lord of Secrets, the Vajra-Holder,
who is fearsome in his victory over the afflictions,
the Sovereign, Victor over the three realms —
therefore, one who is endowed with diligence
should accomplish this through the most intensive practice.
He who heals the wounded mind that has become firm —
he is the Victor, the Lord of Secrets.

Then the Lord of Secrets himself entered into the samādhi called "Vajra, from which accomplishments (siddhis) are definitively obtained," and from the vajra of his perfectly pure body, speech, and mind arose:

Oṃ vajrapāṇi sarva artha siddhi kuru kuru svāhā.

Having drawn a bindu mark upon the forehead
of a goddess, a nāga, a non-human, a gandharva,
or else a human girl,
and placing an iron hook in her hand,
rely upon a foursquare well-fitted maṇḍala,
and accomplish the practice with a vase.
In a victory vase (vijayakalaśa),
fill it well with medicine and other substances,
wrap it with cloth, and set it in place.
If one accomplishes this continuously from that vase,
the siddhis of pacification, enrichment, and the rest will be attained,
and other accomplishments will be realized as well.

Then the Lord of Secrets (Vajrapāṇi) entered into meditative absorption called the vajra that makes immutable, and from the perfect vajra of body, speech, and mind he drew forth this very mantra that pacifies all poisons:

Oṃ nagune prota gamani carapor aṃ ya ra varāhyai da hari naṃ braṃ.

Having poured water into a jeweled vessel,
recite this king of mantras
from one hundred up to one thousand times,
and it will dispel the poison-sicknesses of beings.

Furthermore, the king of secret mantras,
recited many times together
with the application of the Lord of Secrets,
whatever one undertakes through this practice will be accomplished.

At the time when a lunar eclipse occurs, draw a bindu mark on the forehead with gorochana paste, then face east and recite this secret mantra, and it will bring whatever one desires under one's power. Likewise, when the moon or sun is seized by a eclipsing planet, anoint one's body with human blood from the hide of a nāga and recite this mantra, and all nāgas will come under one's power. Of this there is no doubt.

Further applications will now be explained.

With saffron and musk,
write upon a wheel of eight spokes
the first four mantras
and the final mantras as well.
On the two rims, write in sequence
the king of root secret mantras.
Place a jeweled vessel there, make offerings,
recite the mantra one thousand times or more,
then raise it to the tip of a victory banner,
and it will cut the vidyā-mantras of others.

If one wishes to bring down rain, make a foursquare earth maṇḍala. In the center, draw a lotus of eight petals, and upon it set images of the eight nāga kings. Then visualize oneself as the wrathful king (krodharāja) clad in blue robes. Make offerings of various medicines, milk, rice porridge, yogurt, and the like, as well as molasses, sugar, and so forth. Then, having put on white garments, recite a sound like the roar of a Hūṃ like thunder. By reciting the

king of mantras that summoning rain, one causes rain to fall. If it still does not fall, in order to threaten the nāgas, perform a fire offering upon that maṇḍala using various types of blood and poisonous wood and the like. That will swiftly bring down rain.

If one wishes to stop excessive rain or to cut hail, write the mantra upon a branch of birchwood and a root of poisonous kadamba, insert it in the center of a white maṇḍala, then recite the mantra many times over white mustard seed and ash. Even if one does not wish to act thus, it will certainly come to pass merely by the praise-recitation.

It restores to health one who has fainted from horse blood and various poisons.

If one wishes to calm a wind-storm, write the mantra at the peak of a mountain on the garment of a powerful lord using a pine-leaf stylus, then place it upon the maṇḍala, recite the king of mantras one thousand times or as many as one is able, and set it on top of a building; it will pacify the wind.

If one wishes to pacify an epidemic, write it in saffron and the finest musk on a twelve-petaled form, writing the first mantras and the final mantras on the spokes and the remaining mantras on the rim. Make offerings of all manner of yellow flowers and fruits, offer prayers, and then tie it to the pinnacle of a temple or to the lintel of a door of a Saṅgha assembly hall. Whatever one desires will be accomplished, and all plagues and diseases will be quelled.

If one wishes for a son, perform a fire offering upon the trunk of a reddish-white citrus tree, and it is certain that a son will be given.

If one desires treasure, make an image of Vaiśravaṇa (the son of Vaiśravaṇa, a guardian deity of wealth) one cubit tall from earth or from a precious substance, set it upon a precious stone or a flat stone, present various offerings, and offer prayers. Within seven days he will grant precious wealth.

If one fears death, make a round yellow maṇḍala one cubit in measure, place a fine vase in the center, fill it with various medicines, cover its mouth with white cloth, and

recite the king of secret mantras many times, and afterward receive the attainment from the vase — whatever one desires will be accomplished. By performing this again and again, the attainment of long life will be obtained.

If one desires supreme attainment, make an image of Vajrapāṇi — one face, two hands — seated upon a lotus-and-sun throne, fashioned from earth or a

precious substance, place it in a precious vessel, and on top of a white maṇḍala measuring one cubit in extent, set it upon a small throne. Offer worship with flowers and white cloth, and offer as much as one is able with white sandalwood water. Further, on the eighth, fourteenth, and fifteenth days of the month, and on clear-sky days at those times, observe the fasting practice. Afterward, recite the secret mantra eight thousand times; and, visualizing the white syllable OM at one's own crown radiating light and raining down nectar, meditate that all diseases of the three realms are exhausted, and then visualize that they gradually dissolve back into oneself. This is the meditative concentration established from the tantra. By habituating oneself to it, all desires whatsoever will be accomplished, and one will become the sovereign of the three realms.

Vajra-holder, lord of secrets, hear this from me:

The body that has conquered all worlds,
the very nature of all buddhas,
from what is shared out of it
the most excellent means of obtaining all one desires arises.

If there is freedom from conceptuality and separation from it,
primordial wisdom itself is supreme, unsurpassed.

By the power of the Victors, one comes to understand it.

It conquers all afflictions,
exhausts all diseases,
and, if one is without disease, can cause disease.

Empowerment, invigoration, drawing in,
stupefaction, slaying, sovereignty,
pacification, warding off, the bringing of glory,
and the utter ruin of adversaries —
what need is there to speak of the subtle attainments?

The body of bliss liberated from the world
is excellently obtained through the speech of the Victors.
The body is here beyond all expression
and transcends all modes of conduct.

When freed from name and assembly,
it utterly transcends the peace of elaboration;
it is wholly free from the domain of words.
To those at the vajra gate,

the true meaning of these things will be understood.

Otherwise, even in a thousand aeons,
how could one ever come to know it?

If one desires the exhaustion of all reference points,
settle one's own mind upon that which is without reference point
and free from conceptual elaboration.

Through liberation, one is freed within that.

If there is joy and mind exists —
knowing this reality, why should it be empty?

That emptiness, free from elaboration —
what does awareness itself depend upon?

This practice of fierce secret mantras
must not be shown even a single letter
to one who has not been given empowerment and permission,
to one of evil conduct, to one of slight youth,
to one puffed up with pride and arrogance,
and to one without devotion to the Great Vehicle.

If someone confused on a hundred paths
were to teach it, it would be their own undoing.

Having spoken thus, that ray of light called "Conqueror Over the Three Realms" was gathered back into the heart of the main deity. All faces merged into the face, all hands merged into the hands, and it became one face and two hands. Then it sang a song of HŪṂ HŪṂ HŪṂ:

However one meditates upon this,
visualization will extend to all the gods.

When the secret mantra has been recited one hundred thousand times,
this supreme approach-recitation will be accomplished.

Buddhas of the past, the present, and those to come
have all taught this mantra.

This is the secret of all buddhas,
and it is called Great Primordial Wisdom.

Then all those in the retinue were absorbed into the heart of the principal deity.

O great Vajra!
Vajrapāṇi, mighty in strength,
has become the holder of the secret treasury
of all buddhas of the three times.

This concludes the chapter called "Conquest Over the Three Realms" from the tantra of Bhagavān Vajrapāṇi of the Blue Garment, Vajra of Exaltation.

This was translated and revised and definitively established by the paṇḍita Ādyaśrīmati and the Tibetan translator, the monk Chökyi Wangchuk Drakpa.

Translator's Notes

- The title in Sanskrit is preserved as given, representing a tantric text called "Vajrapāṇi Who Wears the Blue Garment, the Resounding Vajra Tantra, Victor over the Three Realms." The Sanskrit transliteration in the manuscript is irregular in places, as is common in Tibetan canonical transcriptions.

The passage describing the five-stage arising of the deity — emptiness, the syllable Hūṃ, the nine-pointed vajra, the Blessed One as Lord of Secrets, and the complete deity — follows the standard tantric deity-generation sequence known from Vajrapāṇi sādhana literature.

The "house of Yama" is the abode of the lord of death, here listed among fearful places suitable for intense practice, in keeping with the antinomian logic of Vajrayāna.

The phrase rendered "he who heals the wounded mind that has become firm" is syntactically compressed in the Tibetan and the precise referent is somewhat elliptical; the reading given is contextually plausible but could also be construed as describing the practitioner whose resolve, once shaken, is restored.

- The mantra syllables in both the dhāraṇī and the rain-ritual passage are transliterated as they appear in the Tibetan without normalization, since their Sanskrit reconstruction is uncertain and they function as fixed liturgical forms.

The term rendered "horse blood" in the revival instruction may refer to a specific pharmacological or ritual ingredient; the passage is terse and its precise application is unclear.

The phrase "garment of a powerful lord" renders རྩམས་པོའི་ཁྱུང་ལྗོངས་, literally "the garment of Īśvara or a lord of power"; this likely refers to a cloth belonging to a ruler or powerful figure used as a ritual support, though a reference to Śiva's garment is also possible.

The translation ends mid-sentence as the source passage does; the text continues beyond what was supplied.

- The verse section contains several compressed and difficult lines. The phrase rendered "from what is shared out of it" reflects a syntactically compact Tibetan construction describing how attainments are distributed or apportioned from the body of all buddhas; the precise doctrinal referent is somewhat elliptical in the original. The line "if one is without disease, can cause disease" preserves a deliberate paradox in the text contrasting the mantra's healing and harmful capacities. The name Ādyaśrīmati is the Sanskrit form given in the Tibetan transliteration and is preserved as such.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.